BEWARE THE VAMPIRE!

Project workbook

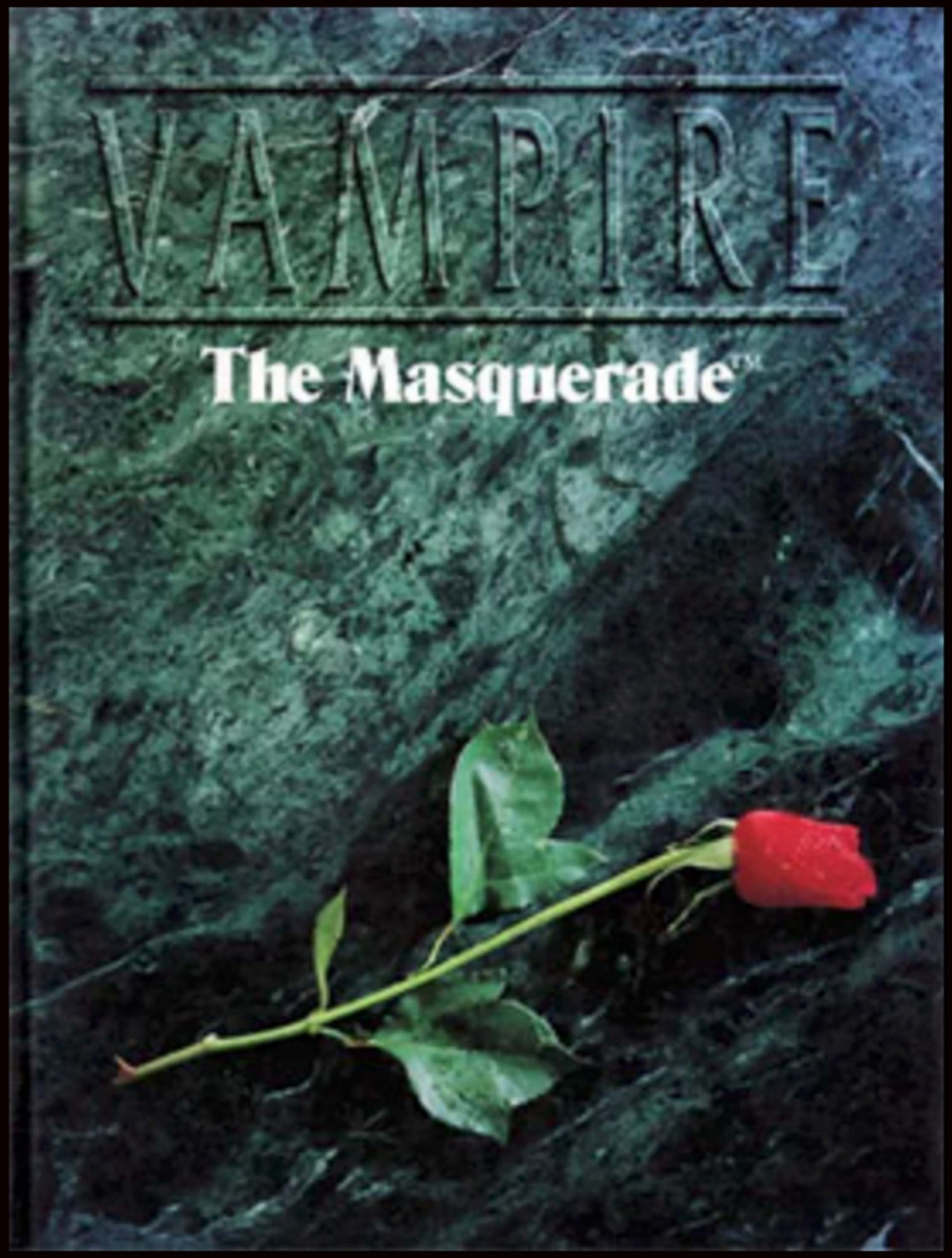
RATIONALE

Inspired by my friends and I's Vampire: The Masquerade tabletop sessions, and being a little bit sad that they had to get put on hold due to other commitments, I wanted to create a poster inspired by Vampire: The Masquerade. Since the actual game is already very established though, I decided to create a poster that is set in that world which would be a PSA poster issued by the vampire hunters within that world that warns the public about vampires. I wanted to achieve this with a sinister, supernatural feel that encompasses the idea of a dangerous vampire that you need to protect yourself from, while also providing some brief information on what to do when you encounter one.

Precedent 1:

Vampire: The Masquerade

Vampire: The Masquerade is a tabletop game developed by White Wolf. I've included Vampire: The Masquerade in here because it what led to me making this my project. I also designed the poster with the perspective of the vampire hunters within this world in mind as I felt they were a solid base for figuring out what I wanted to make the posters appear like and have them communicate.



White Wolf. (1992). Vampire: The Masquerade Second Edition Cover [Cover].

Note:

In my original assignment, I used copyrighted imagery and names from WhiteWolf in my poster design. Since I am unable to remove the logo from the iterations, I have only removed it and replaced it in the final iterations and final poster. All iterations have the copyrighted imagery covered, but since I want it to be clear where the logo originally was, it will be covered with a white shape so you can see where the logo is being moved.

Precedent 2:

Nosferatu: A Symphony of Horror.

'Nosferatu: A Symphony of Horror' is a silent vampire film made by F. W. Murnau in 1922 (Wikipedia Contributors, 2019). I chose for this film to be one of my precedents as I believd it would give me a strong basis for figuring out how I wanted to portray the vampire in my poster. The vampire in these shots is shown as a scary figure, and I want to incorporate this into my photography so my vampire can demonstrate the same sense of danger that you would want in a warning poster about vampires.



Muranu, F. W. (Director). (1922). *Nosferatu: A Symphony of Horror* [Film].

Precedent 3:

Ted Smith

Ted Smith is a photographer who works in black and white photography, using lighting as a tool to sculpt his final image and make it evoke a certain mood (Smith, 2026). For this project, I am specifically taking inspiration from his project 'Vampirique', which has photos that are meant to capture the sinister allure of vampires. While I will take less of his idea of an allure of vampires as that is not the feeling I want my work to evoke, I will take inspiration from his bold lighting and black and white photography to aid in creating a specific mood I want for my work.





Smith, T. (2025). *Vampirique* [Photograph].

Precedent 4:

NZ Transport Agency (Waka Kotahi)

For poster ideas, I will be using NZTA's campaigns as they do a very good job at conveying their warnings by showing a very real situation that can happen as a result of driving under influence or not slowing down, which is something I want for my posters. I want to take their use of composition of shots and their very clear messaging using an image of the situation they're warning against and use it for my works.



NZTA. (2025). Don't let the drugs drive [Image].



NZTA. (2022). Please Slow Down [Image].

Precedent 5:

Wellington Paranormal

Furthermore, I will also be using Wellington Paranormal as inspiration for my poster as they do a good job at mixing reality with something that isn't from our reality, which is something that would need to be done in a poster warning against vampires because even though vampires do exist in V:TM, they aren't something everyone knows about and people believe they're not real, so I would need to make a blend to make it feel like it is something you should be worried about. I like that this poster has a clear main text 'Wanted for Possession', before your eye follows down and lands on 'Wellington Paranormal'. I want to make sure to incorporate theses things into my poster.



Clement, J. (2018). Wellington Paranormal. TVNZ 2.

TYPEFACES:

THEY PERISHED

Category: Horror

Designer: Chris Vile

Foundry: FontMonger

Seems to have been created 22nd March, 2016

I unfortunately cannot give information as to who else has used this typeface as I haven't seen it used elsewhere, I selected it because I felt it evoked a good feeling of danger that I would want in a warning poster.

Bodoni 72 Book

Category: Display Serif

Subfamily of Bodoni 72

Designer: Dmitry Kirsanov

While I don't have examples of where this subfamily was used, Bodoni has been used by many logos in the past as it is very classic. I believe it will work well for my posters as it is a clear typeface that also allows for the vampire hunters to appear to have a sense of professionalism in the eyes of the public.

PHOTOGRAPHIC DEVELOPMENT



Exposure	1/6s
Aperture	ƒ/3.5
ISO	200
Focal Length	18.0mm



Exposure	1/6s
Aperture	ƒ/3.5
ISO	1,600
Focal Length	18.0mm



Exposure	1/6s
Aperture	ƒ/3.5
ISO	800
Focal Length	18.0mm



Exposure	1/6s
Aperture	ƒ/3.5
ISO	100
Focal Length	18.0mm



Exposure	1/6s
Aperture	ƒ/3.5
ISO	100
Focal Length	18.0mm



Exposure	1/6s
Aperture	ƒ/3.5
ISO	100
Focal Length	18.0mm



Exposure	1/6s
Aperture	ƒ/3.5
ISO	100
Focal Length	18.0mm



Exposure	1/6s
Aperture	ƒ/3.5
ISO	100
Focal Length	18.0mm



Exposure	1/6s
Aperture	ƒ/3.5
ISO	200
Focal Length	18.0mm

For this shoot, I wanted to try out photographing a vampire at the door with the implication being they are asking to be let in, playing on the idea that vampires need to be invited in. I set it up so the door would be a bit off centre as I had originally planned for the to be text on the right once it becomes a poster. While I liked the first two shots, I wanted to make the contrast between the light and shadows stronger to put more emphasis on the vampire at the door and for there to not be as much light above the door, so I lowered the ISO so less light would show up. I also did small tests with the vampire further away from the door, but I felt having the vampire closer to the door was more interesting and emphasized them being a shadowy scary being. I really liked how the shadow showed up due to the light from behind them, so I wanted to see how I could play into this more. I also tried some shots with the vampire holding the lantern and then an unidentifiable hand holding the lantern to see how that would work, but I felt it was adding too much to a shot that worked a lot better when it was simpler. I got the vampire to try holding the cloak out to the sides so I could see if we could make the shadow on the ground and on the vampire contrast more with the background. For the final shot on the left, I got them to stand on the edge of the door frame so they could take up more space and appear more threatening.

PHOTOGRAPHIC DEVELOPMENT



Exposure	8s
Aperture	ƒ/5.3
ISO	100
Focal Length	48.0mm



Exposure	4s
Aperture	ƒ/5.3
ISO	200
Focal Length	48.0mm



Exposure	4s
Aperture	ƒ/5.3
ISO	100
Focal Length	48.0mm



Exposure	8s
Aperture	ƒ/5.3
ISO	100
Focal Length	48.0mm



Exposure	8s
Aperture	ƒ/5.3
ISO	100
Focal Length	48.0mm

For this shot, I wanted to have the vampire wander the streets at night, playing into vampires only being out at night. While I did run a few shoots where I had the shutter speed very low so I could get a blur effect, which I found interesting, I felt it just made the vampire too hard to identify even as a figure and I didn't want that as it would mean the danger isn't clear to those I am trying to warn. I decided to instead get the vampire to appear as if they are walking down the street but not to move so I could get a clear shot of them on the street at night. I quite liked this shot because it had a slight eerienes to it and because of the street lamp behind the vampire, it looks a little bit like a moon beaming down from the sky which adds very well to this supernatural feeling. Along with this, the street lamps allowed for there to be interesting lighting as shadows were cast in a direction the contradicted the 'moon', making the vampire seem more unnatural. Because of this, I chose for the image on the left to be my final iteration of this shot.

Note: All license plates have been censored, however since this was all stuff done during development, it wasn't done cleanly.

PHOTOGRAPHIC DEVELOPMENT



Exposure	3s
Aperture	ƒ/3.5
ISO	1,600
Focal Length	18.0mm



Exposure	2s
Aperture	ƒ/4.5
ISO	25,600
Focal Length	34.0mm



Exposure	8s
Aperture	ƒ/4.5
ISO	1,600
Focal Length	34.0mm



Exposure	8s
Aperture	ƒ/4.5
ISO	1,600
Focal Length	34.0mm

For this shot, I wanted to play around further with lighting by making the vampire visible through a very faint light. The first shot had too much noise, but I got the settings right on the next one to allow for the photo to show a shadowy figure illuminated by the light. For the third one I did have struggles getting the lantern in, but the fourth one managed to do a nice job capturing the lantern and the vampire, so I chose for that one to be my last one of this shoot.

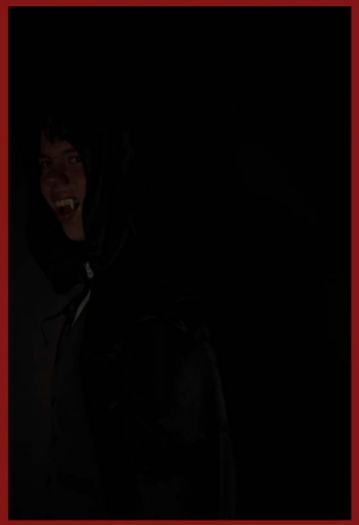
PHOTOGRAPHIC DEVELOPMENT



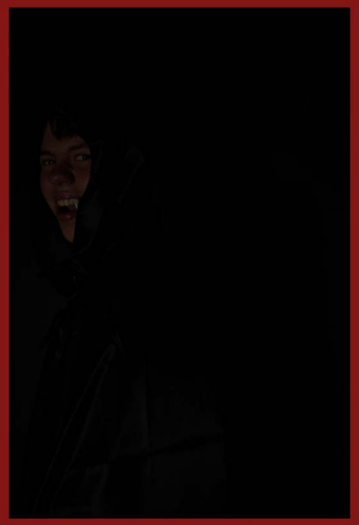
Exposure	8s
Aperture	ƒ/5.3
ISO	100
Focal Length	48.0mm



Exposure	1/2s
Aperture	ƒ/5
ISO	100
Focal Length	40.0mm



Exposure	1/4s
Aperture	ƒ/4.2
ISO	100
Focal Length	31.0mm



Exposure	1/4s
Aperture	ƒ/4.2
ISO	100
Focal Length	31.0mm

For this one, I wanted to try out having the vampire be a cloaked figure obscured by shadows while also maintaining the scary aspect of the vampire. The first shot didn't have this, so I got my vampire to put on some fake fangs and retry it with just them looking at the camera. I then got them to do a glare at the camera while flaring the cloak out, and that gave me the result I wanted.

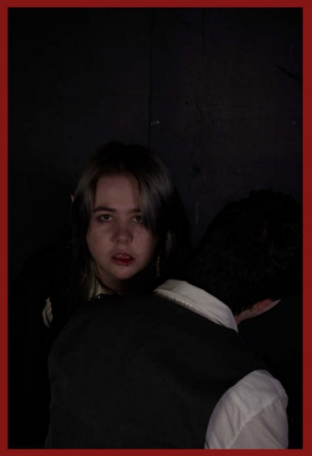
PHOTOGRAPHIC DEVELOPMENT



Exposure	1/8s
Aperture	ƒ/5.6
ISO	200
Focal Length	52.0mm



Exposure	1/8s
Aperture	ƒ/5.3
ISO	200
Focal Length	46.0mm



Exposure	1/8s
Aperture	ƒ/5.3
ISO	200
Focal Length	46.0mm



Exposure	1/8s
Aperture	ƒ/5.6
ISO	200
Focal Length	52.0mm



Exposure	1/8s
Aperture	ƒ/5.3
ISO	200
Focal Length	48.0mm

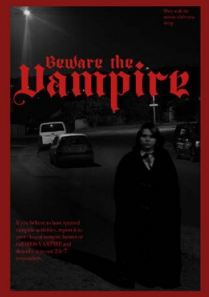
For this one, I wanted to show a vampire attack through the usual way of biting the neck but instead the vampire is caught in the act. I originally planned for it to be an over the should style shot, but after that clearly didn't work in a nice way, the vampire was moved to be facing the camera with the victim being in front on them leaning over as if injured. I did some tests with different lighting and expressions, and settled on the image on the left as it showed a sense of danger and feralness which is important for an image showing a scary vampire, but was also rather clear and it was easy to identify the vampire.

POSTER DEVELOPMENT

ITERATIONS OF SECOND AND FOURTH PHOTOS - WALK THE STREETS:





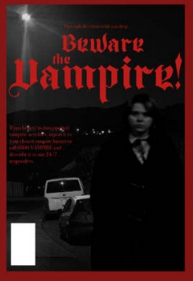


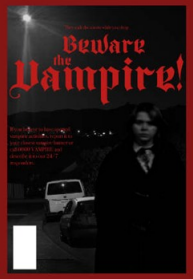




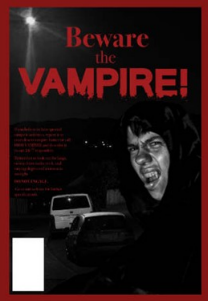




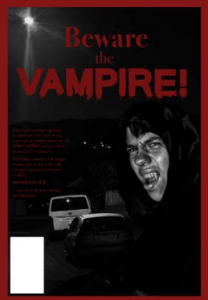


















For this poster attempt, I was originally working with the shot of the vampire walking down the street with a different typeface to what I used for my final. I liked it because it seemed very vampire-esque, but I realised that if I wanted the message to be clear, I should choose a typeface that is less fancy with clearer letters so I switched to 'They Perished'. I wanted it to be obviously vampire from a glance, but there were issues because the identity of my figure was noted to not be clear as to whether it was a vampire or a vampire hunter. Because of this, I decided to edit in the photo I took of the vampire in the cloak who had obvious fangs, allowing for clearer identification. Beyond this, I was also shown a study that showed how temperature can be important when it comes to posters, specifically how in cooler months, you should aim for the advertising to be warmer even if the message isn't (Massey, 2018), so I changed the red to be warmer as we're heading into a cooler temperature. I also had to edit the background so there was less clutter with the cars, but I made sure to keep the moon visible as it was a key piece to the poster in my opinion. I also did some work on my body paragraph, and chose to make the text mostly the same red as the title but have the bits of the paragraph I wanted to be more significant be in an almost white so they stood out. I also did some mixing of the typefaces with the title, but it was noted to be a bit unresolved and I decided to instead make the typeface just one. I also refined how I wanted the text to align with the logo as well. I did originally have a slight subtitle, but it felt wrong so I took it out in later iterations.

POSTER DEVELOPMENT

ITERATIONS OF THIRD PHOTO - THE LIGHT:



For this one, I wanted to have the vampire's disdain for the light highlighted so I started by scaling the photo up so the expression was more visible. I was also still working with my previous typeface at this point. I was mostly moving the photo around and figuring out where best to position it so it could capture both the lamp and the vampire, but I was also figuring out where I wanted my typeface to go as I wanted to try having it sit on the bottom. However, there was struggles with this one which was part of the influence of my switch to 'They Perished' as it was hard to make the typeface fit together nicely. I also hadn't changed the photo to black and white yet so I did that in my final one. I also felt that for my final one, while I liked the emphasis on the expression, it didn't leave a lot of room for the body paragraph. I decided to then shrink it down and also take the typeface from my 'walking the street' poster and I felt it fit together a lot better and still kept the elements I wanted it to have. However, I didn't work that much more with this one as I felt it just wasn't strong enough.

POSTER DEVELOPMENT

ITERATIONS OF FIRST PHOTO - AT THE DOOR:



When it came to this one, I had already done a fair bit of work and learned from my previous iterations about how to focus something in a poster. I decided I wanted it to have this spooky, shadowy aura to it and made the contrast high emphasize the difference of the light and the shadow. I originally had the light that shone in from the left but I felt that it would be better to have it all focus on the figure in the door so I edited it out. I also had the typography look more like the one from the street poster, but then I changed it. Despite this, I still felt that it could be made stronger, so I tried moving the position of the door. I made it sit in the center and I believed that was the strongest one for it. I moved the body paragraph to be below the figure and place the logo next to the paragraph, leading to a very clean look.

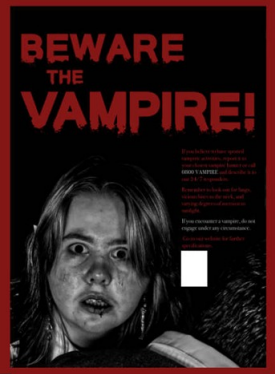
POSTER DEVELOPMENT

ITERATIONS OF FIFTH PHOTO - BITE THE NECK:

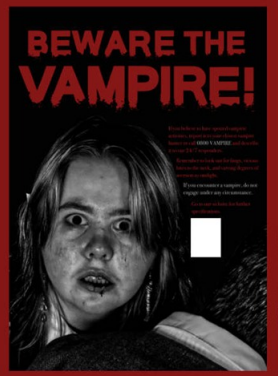








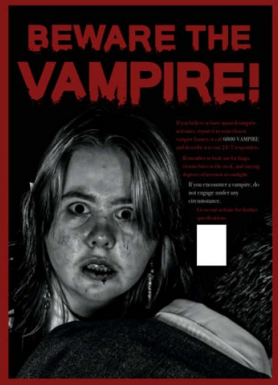










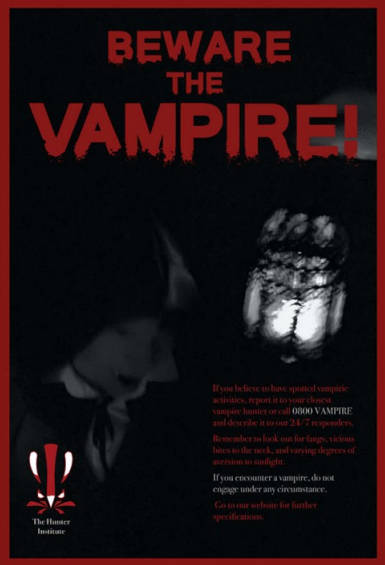


I wanted to really emphasize the vampire being a scary creature in this one so I began it by cutting out the background as I felt it would lead to distractions from the vampire due to the background being rather messy. I also did some changes with the clarity of the image to try to make the vampire seem a bit more inhuman. I started out by just formating where I wanted the text, body paragraph, and logo to go. I also decided that in order to make the vampire appear more feral and bloody, I edited the eyes so there would be no shine in them and added more blood to further give this sense of danger, feralness, and violence, which worked very well for what I wanted. While I did like my early iterations, the composition was bothering me because the body text being below the logo felt a little bit odd and it felt like my eye had no clear path, so I decided to rearrange it so that it could be below it. It couldn't comfortably go on the people in the photo so I decided I would try to fit it just beneath the body paragraph as there was room. I found it to be nice, but the composition then felt a bit empty and jagged as there was pockets of empty space that didn't really work. While I did like how the title looked in the early iterations of this one, I believed for the sake of the whole I should make it take up more space at the top. Furthermore, I felt it would be beneficial to see if I could mold the body paragraph around the head so it would click together nicer. While I originally wasn't big on the change of positions and switched back, I decided to give it another shot and also scale up the size of the image. After that attempt, I actually rather liked how it looked. I did play around with maybe bringing back a bit of the intrigue of the previous titles, but I felt it would be better for them to be more balanced with each other. I did get a bit annoyed with some of the posters because there was a little sliver of black in the bottom right corner that I found distracting so I edited it out for a cleaner image. I added some more blood to increase the feeling of danger from the vampire, and after trying one more change in the composition, I settled on what I wanted this poster to look like.

POSTER DEVELOPMENT

LINE UP AND SELECTION OF FINAL:







With these four being my final options, I believe the best one to be the final poster is the one on the right. Although I do like the other ones, and the one with the vampire at the door came close, this one had a stronger sense of danger and feralness to the vampire that isn't portrayed as well in the other ones. Furthermore, as pointed out to me, this one would more quickly catch the eye to someone walking by as the vampire is looking directly at the camera, which would likely be caught in the corner of someone's eye in a way the others don't, which I would want if I was warning about vampires and needed to make sure the general public was aware of them and understood they were dangerous.



BEWARE THE VAMPIRE!



If you believe to have spotted vampiric activities, report it to your closest vampire hunter or call 0800 VAMPIRE and describe it to our 24/7 responders.

Remember to look out for fangs, vicious bites to the neck, and varying degrees of aversion to sunlight.

If you encounter a vampire, do not engage under any circumstance.

Go to our website for further specifications.

The Hunter Institute

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